

CATHERINE CHEN

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catherinechen@lsu.edu ◊ [Personal Website](#) ◊ [Google Scholar](#)

ACADEMIC POSITION

Mary P. Poindexter Assistant Professor in Political Communication

August 2024 -

Louisiana State University

Manship School of Mass Communication

Department of Political Science

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Communication, Stanford University

June 2024

Advisor: Jon A. Krosnick

Dissertation: *The Origins of Citizens' Policy Agendas in the US: Studies on Public Perceptions of the Seriousness of Global Warming*

Committee: Jon A. Krosnick, James S. Fishkin, Jennifer Pan, Allyson L. Holbrook

External Chair: Neil Malhotra

M.A. in Political Science, Stanford University

December 2021

M.S. in Journalism, Northwestern University

June 2017

B. SoSc. in Communication, Hong Kong Baptist University

May 2016

First Class Honor

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

6. Rosales Cortez, O. & **Chen, C.** (2026). Where on Earth Are the Earth Sciences? A Mixed-Methods Study of Environmental Justice Research Trends and Roadblocks to Engagement. *Geohealth*, 10(9), e2025GH001799. <https://doi.org/10.1029/2025GH001799>
5. Wang, R. Y. & **Chen, C.** (2026). Beyond Keywords: Comparing LLM-Assisted Topic Modeling Approaches Across Political Communication Contexts. *Computational Communication Research*, 8(2) 1-42. <https://doi.org/10.5117/CCR2026.2.12.WANG>
4. **Chen, C.** & Jia, X. (2026). When Researchers Use AI: Public Trust, Ethical Judgments, and the Perceived Value of Academic Research. *AI & Ethics*, 6(2), 223. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s43681-026-01039-w>
3. **Chen, C.** & Cui, Z. (2025). Impact of AI-Assisted Diagnosis on American Patients' Trust in and Intention to Seek Help From Health Care Professionals: Randomized, Web-Based Survey Experiment. *Journal of Medical Internet Research*, 27, e66083. <https://doi.org/10.2196/66083>
Media coverage by [Health Exec](#)
2. **Chen, C.**, Cui, Z., & Chen, Y. (2023). A randomized controlled trial of an information intervention to bolster COVID-19 vaccination intention among people with purity concerns. *Health Psychology*, 42(9), 686-697. <https://doi.org/10.1037/hea0001295>
1. **Chen, C.**, MacInnis, B., Waltman, M., & Krosnick, J. A. (2021). Public opinion on climate change in the USA: to what extent can it be nudged by questionnaire design features? *Climatic Change*, 167(3), 1-18. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10584-021-03194-x>

BOOK CHAPTERS

1. **Chen, C.**, MacInnis, B. & Krosnick, J. A. (2025). American Public Opinion on Climate Change. In M. Lackner, B. Sajjadi & W. Chen (Eds.), *Handbook of Climate Change Mitigation and Adaptation* (pp. 409-494). Springer. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-1-4614-6431-0_190-1

UNVER REVIEW

1. Yang, S. X., Weng, G., Cui, S., Chen, Z., & **Chen, C.** Socioeconomic Gradients in Post-Flood Mobility: Evidence from Two Secondary Cities in Monsoon Asia. 2nd round R & R at *Communications Earth & Environment*
2. **Chen, C.** Does the News-Finds-Me Mindset lead to the Erosion of Political Participation?
3. **Chen, C.** Cui, S., & Geng, F. Regulatory Approval, AI Function, and Patient Acceptance of AI-Assisted Health Care in the United States and China
4. Nepomuceno, A. & **Chen, C.** An Inclusive Scientist Identity Intervention Strengthens Scientist Identity and Motivation to Improve Science Skills
5. Gui, F., Rothenberg, L., Ouyang, Y., & **Chen, C.** Getting Support from Your Colleague: Bill Reintroduction in the U.S. House.
6. Li, L., Li, J., **Chen, C.**, ... & Dong, Y. Political-LLM: Large Language Models in Political Science. [\[arxiv preprint\]](#)

SELECTED WORKS IN PROGRESS

7. w. Chenxiao Yu, Ojas Nimase, Phillip Huang, Lincan Li, Hongjia Yang, Yue Zhao, Xiyang Hu, & Yushun Dong. Do silicon samples satisfice? Response option order bias in LLM-based survey simulations.
6. w. Josh Jackson. AI aversion in sports journalism
5. w. Rachel Bailey. Predicting the public's willingness to try cultured meat
4. w. Fanny Ramirez, Janice Lee, Hayley Booth, Caley Hewitt, Morgan Badurak, & Nabila Mushtarin. The TikTok Ban as a Breakup Story: Digital Mourning, State Paternalism, and Community
3. w. Morgan Badurak, Caley Hewitt, Adowa Baffour, Kristina Shustova, Madeline Lepisto, Hayley Booth, Nabila Mushtarin, Julia Narh, Nildy Chapman-Sanchez, Janice Lee, & Fanny Ramirez. Peer Networks of Accountability: Location Sharing and Collective Safety Among College Students
2. w. Chun Yang. Does Moral Disgust Exist? A Physiological and Conceptual Examination
1. w. Moumita Roy & Chun Yang. Clickbait vs. Non-Clickbait Headlines: Eye-Tracking Evidence Across Image Types and Locations.

GRANTS

- NSF - Fueling the Future for Louisiana (FUEL) & the LSU Institute for Energy Innovation (IEI) (\$231,963)
Public Perceptions of Renewable Energy and Carbon Capture in Louisiana
PI: **Catherine Chen**
CO-I: Sabarethinam Kameshwar, Xugui Zhou 2025–2026
- LSU Office of Research and Economic Development Summer Grant (\$1,200) 2025
- Stanford Center for Democracy (SCAD) Survey Experiment Grant (\$2,000) 2023-2024
- Rapoport Family Foundation Doctoral Dissertation Grant (\$15,000) 2023-2024
- Stanford Department of Communication Travel Grant (\$2,400) 2021-2022
- IRiSS Small Data Acquisition Grant (\$1,500) 2020-2021

- Stanford Department of Communication Summer Research Fund (\$6,000) 2020
- Stanford Department of Communication Travel Grant (\$2,400) 2018-2019

HONORS & FELLOWSHIPS

- Mary P. Poindexter Endowed Professorship, Louisiana State University 2024-present
- Stanford Institute for Research in the Social Sciences (IRiSS) Dissertation Fellowship 2023-2024
- SAP Fellow, Stanford Graduate Fellowship in Science and Engineering 2021-2023
- American Democracy Graduate Fellow, IRiSS 2020-2021
- Melville J. Jacoby Fellowship, Stanford University 2018-2020; 2023-2024
- Hong Kong Baptist University President's Honor Roll 2012-2016
- PCCW - HKT Scholarship 2015
- Hong Kong Baptist University Dean's List 2013-2014

SELECTED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

36. Badurak, M., Hewitt, C., Baffour, A., Shustova, K., Lepisto, M. P., Booth, H., Mushtarin, N., Narh, J. K., Chapman-Sanchez, N. M., **Chen, C.**, Lee, J., & Ramirez, F. (2026, November). "If Something Happens, They'll Know": Location Sharing, Peer Networks of Accountability, and What Colleges Can Learn from Student Safety Practices. Paper to be presented at the 112th Annual Convention of the National Communication Association (NCA), New Orleans, LA.
 - Top Paper Award, Applied Communication Division
35. **Chen, C.**, Yu, C., Nimase, O., Huang, P., Li, L., Yang, H., Zhao, Y., Hu, X., & Dong, Y. (2026, September). *Do Silicon Samples Satisfice? Response Option Order Bias in LLM-Based Survey Simulations*. Paper presented at the APSA Political Communication & PaCSS Preconference, Boston, MA.
34. Badurak, M., Hewitt, C., Baffour, A., Shustova, K., Lepisto, M., Booth, H., Mushtarin, N., Narh, J., Chapman-Sanchez, N., **Chen, C.**, Lee, J., & Ramirez, F. (2026, August). *"Someone's Always Watching (for You)": Location Sharing, Peer Networks of Accountability, and College Safety Practices*. Paper to be presented at the 109th Annual Conference of the Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication (AEJMC), New Orleans, LA.
33. **Chen, C.** & Jia, X. (2026, June). *When Researchers Use AI: Public Trust, Ethical Judgments, and the Perceived Value of Academic Research*. Paper presented at the 76th Annual Conference of the International Communication Association (ICA), Cape town, South Africa.
32. **Chen, C.**, Cui, Z., & Geng, F. (2026, May). *Public Preferences for Health Care Artificial Intelligence in the United States and China: A Conjoint Experiment*. Paper presented at Comm Horizons @ UCD 2026: Communication in the Age of AI and Algorithms, Davis, CA.
31. **Chen, C.** & Jia, X. (2026, May). *Where AI Touches the Science Matters: Perceptual Penalties for Generative AI Use in Theory, Methods, and Writing*. Poster presented at Comm Horizons @ UCD 2026: Communication in the Age of AI and Algorithms, Davis, CA.
30. Booth, H., Hewitt, C., Ramirez, F., Mushtarin, N., Badurak, M. M., **Chen, C.**, & Lee, J. J. (2025, November) *From FYP to Farewell: Analyzing User Responses to the TikTok Ban*. Paper presented at the National Communication Association (NCA) 111th Annual Convention, Denver, CO.
29. Mushtarin, N., Badurak, M. M., Lee, J. J., **Chen, C.**, Hewitt, C., Booth, H., & Ramirez, F. (2025, November). *Innovation or Infiltration? The U.S. Media and Public Reactions to China's DeepSeek*. Paper presented at the National Communication Association (NCA) 111th Annual Convention, Denver, CO.

28. Gui, F., Ouyang, Y., & **Chen, C.** (2025, September). *Getting Support from Your Colleague: Bill Reinroduction in the U.S. House*. Paper presented at the 121st American Political Science Association (APSA) Conference, Vancouver, Canada.
27. Nepomuceno, A., & **Chen, C.** (2025, September). *An Inclusive Science Identity Intervention Elicits Action to Improve Science Skills*. Paper presented at the Stanford Big Ideas in Medicine Conference, Stanford, CA.
26. Yang, S. X., Weng, G., Cui, S., **Chen, C.**, , Chen, Z., & Zhu, Y. (2025, April). *Disaster-Driven Climate Migration: Findings from Large Mobile Phone Datasets in India*. Paper presented at the the 120th American Sociological Association (ASA) Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL.
25. Booth, H., Hewitt, C., Ramirez, F., Mushtarin, N., Badurak, M. M., **Chen, C.**, & Lee, J. J. (2025, August) *From FYP to Farewell: Analyzing User Responses to the TikTok Ban*. Poster presented at the 108th Annual Conference of the Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication (AEJMC), San Francisco, CA.
24. Mushtarin, N., Badurak, M. M., Lee, J. J., **Chen, C.**, Hewitt, C., Booth, H., & Ramirez, F. (2025, August). *Innovation or Infiltration? The U.S. Media and Public Reactions to China's DeepSeek*. Poster presented at the 108th Annual Conference of the Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication (AEJMC), San Francisco, CA.
23. **Chen, C.**, Hsiao, T.-K., Chen, P.-Y., & Geng, F. (2025, May). *Communicating AI in public health: Trends from 2000 to 2024*. Paper presented at Comm Horizons @ UCD 2025: Media, Health, and Society, Davis, CA.
22. Apcar, L., Benz, J., Connelly, M., Hinkle, J., Krummenacher, C., & **Chen, C.** (2025, May). *United in Distrust: Assessing Civic Cynicism Beyond the Partisan Divide*. Paper to be presented at the 80th Annual Conference of the American Association for Public Opinion Research (AAPOR), St. Louis, MO.
21. Gui, F., & **Chen, C.** (2025, April). Does the Power Divide Persist? The Influence of Average Citizens and Economic Elites on Public Policy Outcomes. Paper presented at the the 82nd Annual Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Conference, Chicago, IL.
20. Yang, S. X., Weng, G., **Chen, C.**, Cui, S., Chen, Z., & Zhu, Y. (2025, April). *Disaster-Driven Climate Mobility Changes: Findings from Large Mobile Phone Datasets in India, 2019*. Paper presented at the 2025 Annual Meeting of the Population Association of America (PAA), Washington, DC.
19. Weng, G., Yang, S. X., **Chen, C.**, Cui, S., Chen, Z., & Zhu, Y. (2024, October). *Disaster-Driven Climate Mobility Changes: Findings from Large Mobile Phone Datasets in India, 2019*. Paper presented at the 2024 NetMob, Washington, DC.
18. Hu, D., **Chen, C.**, Kathmandu, A., & Cohen, G. L. (2024, February). *When Science Puts on a Human Face: The Trade-off between Knowledge and Utility in Public Perception of Science*. Poster presented at the 2024 Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP) Annual Convention, San Diego, CA.
17. **Chen, C.**, Neufeld, N., & Krosnick, J. A. (2023, November). Elite party cues fail to increase vaccination attitude or intention among Republicans. Paper presented at the National Communication Association (NCA) 109th Annual Convention, National Harbor, MD.
16. **Chen, C.**, Neufeld, N., & Krosnick, J. A. (2023, August). *The Impact of Trump Rhetoric on Attitudes Toward COVID-19 Vaccines and Vaccination Intention: A Randomized Controlled Trial*. Paper presented at the 2023 American Political Science Association (APSA) Political Communication Pre-conference, Los Angeles, CA.
15. **Chen, C.**, Krosnick, J. A. & Fishkin, J. S. (2023, May). *The Impact of Deliberative Polling on Opinionation and Knowledge Acquisition*. Poster presented at the 78th Annual Conference of the American Association for Public Opinion Research (AAPOR), Philadelphia, PA.
14. **Chen, C.**, Neufeld, N., & Krosnick, J. A. (2023, May). *The Impact of Trump Rhetoric on Attitudes Toward COVID-19 Vaccines and Vaccination Intention: A Randomized Controlled Trial*. Paper presented at the 78th

Annual Conference of the American Association for Public Opinion Research (AAPOR), Philadelphia, PA.

13. **Chen, C.**, Neufeld, N., & Krosnick, J. A. (2023, February). *If Trump Brags About COVID-19 Vaccines, Will People Want to Get Vaccinated?* Poster presented at the 2023 Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP) Annual Convention, Atlanta, GA.
12. **Chen, C.**, Cui, Z., & Chen, Y. (2023, February). *Purity-related Cues Improve Republicans' Vaccination Attitude and Intention.* Poster presented at the 2022 Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP) Annual Convention, Atlanta, GA.
11. **Chen, C.** & Krosnick, J. A. (2022, May). *Perceptions of Global Warming as a Serious Problem for the Nation: Testing Propositions of the ACE Model.* Paper presented at the 72nd Annual Conference of the International Communication Association (ICA), Paris, France.
10. **Chen, C.** & Krosnick, J. A. (2020, May). *Do People Lie When Reporting Their Beliefs on Global Warming and Support for Green Policies? A Test Using the Item Count Technique.* Poster presented at the 75th Annual Virtual Conference of the American Association for Public Opinion Research (AAPOR).
9. **Chen, C.**, MacInnis, B., Krosnick, J. A. (2019, December). *Trends in American Public Opinion on Climate Change 1997-2018: Testing Predictions of the ACE Model.* Paper presented at the 2019 Annual Conference of the Pacific Chapter of the American Association for Public Opinion Research (PAPOR), San Francisco, CA.
8. **Chen, C.**, Krosnick, J. A., MacInnis, B., & Waltman, M. (2019, May). *How Often Do Response Effects Occur in Survey Questions?* Paper presented at the 74th Annual Conference of American Association for Public Opinion Research (AAPOR), Toronto, Ontario.
7. **Chen, C.**, Kathmandu, A., Wang, L., Ma, N., Sun, Y., Chen, X., & Cohen, G. L. (2019, February). *Seeking Truth or Helping Human? Framing of Science Affects Judgment of it.* Poster presented at the 2019 Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP) Annual Convention, Portland, OR.
6. **Chen, C.**, Wang, L., Kathmandu, A., & Cohen, G. L. (2018, August). *Congruity in Communal Goals between Liberals and Conservatives.* Talk given at the 2018 American Psychological Association (APA) Annual Convention, San Francisco, CA.
5. Kathmandu, A., **Chen, C.**, Wang, L., & Cohen, G. L. (2018, August). *Judging Science by its Covers: The Framing of Scientific Discoveries Affected Public Judgment.* Poster presented at the 2018 American Psychological Association (APA) Annual Convention, San Francisco, CA.
4. Kathmandu, A., Song, J., Zhang, Y., **Chen, C.**, & Cohen, G. L. (2018, July). *Advanced Machine Learning Algorithms Fail to Generalize Across Cultures.* Poster presented at the 4th Annual International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2), Evanston, IL.
3. Song, J., Kathmandu, A., **Chen, C.** & Zhang, Y. (2018, May). *Can Successful Machine Learning Algorithms Generalize across Cultures? A Case on Predicting Academic Achievement.* Poster presented at the 30th Convention of the American Psychological Society (APS), San Francisco, CA.
2. **Chen, C.**, Kathmandu, A., Wang, L., & Cohen, G. L. (2018, May). *Leverage the Persuasive Power of Technology-related Scientific Discoveries to Close America's Political Divide on Support for Science.* Poster presented at the 30th Convention of the American Psychological Society (APS), San Francisco, CA.
1. Kathmandu, A., Wang, Y., **Chen, C.**, Wang, L., & Cohen, G. L. (2018, March). *How Important Do You Think Science Is? Framing, Judgment, and Politics of Science Discoveries.* Poster presented at the 2018 Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP) Annual Convention, Atlanta, GA.

INVITED TALKS

14. **Chen, C.** (2026, February). *When AI enters high-stakes domains: Human involvement, Responsibility, and Cultural expectations.* Political Psychology Research Group (PPRG) Winter Colloquia, Stanford University.

13. **Chen, C.** (2026, January). *Community Perspectives on Local Energy Sectors*. Southeast Community Energy Futures Academy.
12. **Chen, C.** (2025, November). *What shapes public perception of AI health products? A conjoint experiment approach*. Guest lecture given at JMC 805: Quantitative Methods. William Allen White School of Journalism and Mass Communications, University of Kansas.
11. Nepomuceno, A & **Chen, C.** (2025, May). *Test of a linguistic intervention to build foundational population health infrastructure*. Department of Biomedical Data Science, Stanford University.
10. **Chen, C.** (2024, February). *From Disbelief to Action: Navigating Public Opinion on Nationally Important Problems*. Manship School of Mass Communication, Louisiana State University.
9. **Chen, C.** (2024, January). *Vaccine Hesitancy and Ways to Intervene*. IRiSS Colloquia, Stanford University.
8. **Chen, C.** (2023, November). *Survey Methodology for Future Journalists*. Guest lecture given at MMC 2604: Media, Cultures, and Identity. The College of Journalism and Communications, University of Florida.
7. **Chen, C.** (2023, November). *Origins of National Agenda-Setting for Global Warming (GW): A Psychological Model*. College of Journalism and Communications, University of Florida.
6. **Chen, C.** (2023, November). *Do People Lie When Reporting Their Beliefs on Global Warming and Support for Green Policies? A Test Using the Item Count Technique*. Stanford University Department of Communication Colloquia.
5. **Chen, C.** (2023, October). *Communication strategies to improve COVID-19 vaccination rate*. Political Psychology Research Group (PPRG) Fall Colloquia, Stanford University.
4. **Chen, C.** (2023, October). *Origins of the national agenda-setting for Global Warming (GW): A psychological model*. PPRG Fall Colloquia, Stanford University.
3. **Chen, C.** (2021, May). *Design and Analysis of the Item Count Technique (ICT)*. IRiSS Colloquia, Stanford University.
2. **Chen, C.** (2020, November). *Social Media and Social Capital* Guest Lecture given at COMM 1: Introduction to Communication. Department of Communication, Stanford University.
1. **Chen, C.** (2019, May). *How Often Do Response Effects Occur in Survey Questions?* Political Psychology Research Group (PPRG) Spring Colloquia, Stanford University.

WORKSHOPS/PANELS ORGANIZED

- **Chen, C.** (2026, March). *Writing Compelling Research Narratives*. Manship School of Mass Communication Pathways Workshop Series, Baton Rouge, LA.
- Zhao, W., **Chen, C.**, & Zhang, J. (2024, November). *Evaluating and Enhancing Methods for Narrative Understanding*. The 2024 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP), Miami, FL.

TEACHING

Instructor of record

Louisiana State University

- MC 3505 Media and Policy Processes Spring 2026
- MC 4971 Strategic Persuasion: Influencing Public Opinion and Perceptions Spring 2025
- MC 7005 Public Opinion & Public Affairs Spring 2025, Fall 2025
- MC 7004 News Media & Governance Fall 2024, 2026
- POLI 4030 Political Attitude & Public Opinion Fall 2024, 2025, 2026

AD-HOC REVIEWER

Journal

AI & Ethics (x2), AI & Society, BMC Medical Informatics and Decision Making, Communications AI & Computing, Data & Policy, Humanities and Social Sciences Communications, JMIR AI, Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics, Mass Communication & Society, Nature Cities, npj Digital Medicine (x2), PLOS Neglected Tropical Diseases, PLOS ONE, Quality & Quantity (x2), Social Science Computer Review

Grant

- National Science Foundation - Social, Behavioral and Economic (SBE) Research

MEDIA COVERAGE

- Health Exec (2025). [Why do AI-savvy consumers harbor skepticism toward medical AI?](#)
- Business Report (2025). [From batteries to biofuels, LSU is investing \\$1M in energy research](#)

UNIVERSITY SERVICE

- Research Committee, Department of Political Science, Louisiana State University
- Relationship and Engagement Committee, Manship School of Mass Communication, Louisiana State University

SELECTED PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- | | |
|--|------------------------------|
| • Video Producer, Medill News Service, Chicago, IL | June 2016-December 2016 |
| • Editor, The Young Reporter, Hong Kong | September 2015-February 2016 |
| • Video Producer, Agence France-Presse, Hong Kong | June 2015-August 2015 |
| • Reporter, The Young Reporter, Hong Kong | September 2013-June 2014 |
| • Media Relations Officer, Sina Corp., Dalian, China | June 2014-August 2014 |

SKILLS

- Programming Languages: R, Python, SQL
- Web Markup and Styling Languages: HTML, CSS, Markdown
- Languages: Mandarin (Native), English (Proficient), Cantonese (Proficient), French (Elementary)
- Musical Abilities: Guzheng, vocal skills
- Sports and Athletics: Badminton, running, swimming, cycling

REFERENCES

Jon A. Krosnick

Frederic O. Glover Professor in Humanities and Social Sciences

Professor of Communication

Professor of Political Science

Stanford University

450 Jane Stanford Way

Building 120, Room 432

Stanford, CA 94305-2050

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Jennifer Pan

Sir Robert Ho Tung Professor in Chinese Studies

Professor of Communication

Stanford University

450 Jane Stanford Way

Building 120, Room 330

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James S. Fishkin

Janet M. Peck Professor of International Communication

Professor of Communication

Stanford University

450 Jane Stanford Way

Building 120, Room 350

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Allyson L. Holbrook

Professor of Public Policy, Management, and Analytics

College of Urban Planning & Public Affairs

University of Illinois Chicago

Room 134, 412 S Peoria St

Chicago, IL 60607

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